MOHAMMAD ASIF KHAN, PhD

Professor & Associate Dean, College of Computing & Information Technology (CCIT)

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Two decades · 6 countries · Founding Dean & Centre Director · ~USD 4.3M directed · 7 programmes led · 70+ keynotes · h-index 30 · 3,850+ citations

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PROFILE

Senior academic and research leader with more than two decades of institution-building across six countries at the intersection of **bioinformatics, data science, and AI**. Founding Dean of the first School of Data Sciences in Malaysia, Founding Director of a national bioinformatics centre, and currently **Professor and Associate Dean** at the University of Doha for Science and Technology, where I chair the University's ranking working group and contribute to college-wide accreditation and curriculum. Founder of two ventures, **Editor-in-Chief** of a major Elsevier reference work, and an elected leader of the global bioinformatics community (*ISCB Honorary Director; APBioNet Vice President; GOBLET Chair*). I have attracted and directed ~USD 4.3M in research and institutional funding, led or co-led the development of seven academic programmes, contributed to multiple accreditations, and translated research into tools, patent applications, and partnerships spanning academia, industry, and government.

CORE LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES

Institution & Programme Building · Research & Innovation Strategy · AI / Data Science Leadership · **Accreditation & Academic Quality (ABET, MQA)** · Global Partnerships & Consortia

Governance & Board Service · Academic Entrepreneurship (P&L) · Cross-sector & International Leadership · **Talent Development & Mentorship**

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Professor & Associate Dean, CCIT | University of Doha for Science & Technology, Qatar *2023 – Present*

- Deputise for the Dean on academic matters across the College; **chair or vice-chair 12+ college and university committees** spanning accreditation, curriculum, recruitment, quality assurance, and capstone.
- **Chair, UDST THE/QS Ranking Working Group** — set and drive the institution's global-ranking strategy.
- Vice Chair, CCIT Accreditation Taskforce; **contributed to ABET accreditation** of four BSc programmes (Information Systems and Information Technology, accredited 2026; Data Science & AI and Data & Cybersecurity, under review).
- Chair, UDST Capstone Projects Committee (2024–Present) — university-wide; steers interdisciplinary capstone work in partnership with industry.
- Founding Convenor (2024), Centre of Excellence in Bioinformatics.

Founding Dean, School of Data Sciences | Perdana University, Malaysia *2016 – 2019*

- Established and led the **first School of Data Sciences in Malaysia**; built faculty, curriculum, and postgraduate programmes from inception.
- Senate member; later appointed Chief Data Officer of the University.
- Secured programme accreditation and positioned data science as a strategic institutional pillar.

Founding Director, Centre for Bioinformatics (PU-CBi) | Perdana University, Malaysia *2014 – 2016*

- Founded and directed the University's bioinformatics centre, building research capacity, funding, and international partnerships.
- Delivered as part of the **JHU–Perdana Public-Private Partnership** under Malaysia's Prime Minister's Department.

Founder & CEO — Alterquo (Malaysia); Co-Founder — BioAct (Türkiye) | Academic ventures *2017 – 2023*

- Founder & CEO of **Alterquo** (university spin-off in high-dimensional data services), with full strategic and operational responsibility; Co-Founder and advisor to **BioAct** (clinical-informatics start-up).

Professor (secondee) & TÜBİTAK International Fellow | Bezmialem Vakıf University (BILSAB), Istanbul, Türkiye *2020 – 2023*

- Awarded the **TÜBİTAK International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers** (with research grant); built viral-diversity analytics capability and mentored a cross-border team.

Faculty / Adjunct & Visiting Scientist | Johns Hopkins University, USA *2010 – 2017*

- Selected to the **pioneer team** establishing Perdana University under a JHU collaboration; maintained a JHU faculty affiliation while building capacity in Malaysia.

GOVERNANCE, EDITORIAL & GLOBAL LEADERSHIP

- **Editor-in-Chief**, Encyclopedia of Bioinformatics & Computational Biology, 2nd ed. (Elsevier, 2025); Section Editor, 1st ed. (2018; 334 peer-reviewed contributions).
- **Honorary Director**, International Society for Computational Biology (ISCB), 2025 – Present.
- **Vice President (Operations) & three-term President (2019–2024), Asia-Pacific Bioinformatics Network (APBioNet); Founding Chair, Steering Committee, 1st Asia & Pacific Bioinformatics Joint Congress (APBJC 2024, Okinawa), uniting 15 partner organisations; brokered the 2024 APBioNet–ISCB Memorandum of Understanding.**
- **Chairperson & elected Executive Board member**, GOBLET (Global Organisation for Bioinformatics Learning, Education & Training).
- **Founder & Lead**, Bioinformatics Grand Challenges Consortium (BGCC); Associate Editor, Frontiers in Genetics / Bioengineering & Biotechnology.
- **Vice President & Immediate Past President**, Association for Medical & Bio-Informatics, Singapore (AMBIS).
- **External thesis examiner** for 16 PhD/MSc examinations across ten universities in five countries; reviewer for numerous journals, conferences, and funding agencies.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS & ORGANISATIONAL IMPACT

- Attracted **~USD 4.3M in research and institutional funding** (~USD 2.5M directly managed), including a TÜBİTAK International Fellowship and multi-institutional QRDI grants.
- Led or co-led the development of **seven academic programmes** (undergraduate and postgraduate) as Program Director or new-programme taskforce chair, and contributed to five others, two currently in development. Led the Malaysian Qualifications Agency (MQA) accreditation of two postgraduate programmes at Perdana University (2017) and supported three others; supported the ABET accreditation of four undergraduate programmes at UDST (two accredited, 2026; two under review, site visit November 2026).
- Founded and directed **two research entities and two ventures** across Malaysia, Türkiye, and Qatar.
- Delivered 70+ invited keynotes and plenaries in a dozen-plus countries; organised 80+ international conferences, workshops, and meetings; leads 10 data-science interest groups spanning close to 1,000 practitioners across the Asia-Pacific region.
- Honours: **Outstanding Academic Leadership & Capacity Building Award** (APBioNet–AMBIS–BIC30, NUS, 2026); **TÜBİTAK International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers** (2020–2023); two Best Paper Gold awards (InCoB 2017); Zuckerkandl Prize (2003, as co-author).

RESEARCH & SCHOLARLY IMPACT (CONDENSED)

- **90+ peer-reviewed publications**; 3,850+ citations; h-index 30; i10-index 49 (Google Scholar).
- **Three US patent applications**; 20+ bioinformatics tools and databases developed or co-developed.
- **Graduated 16 doctoral and master's researchers; mentored 100+; taught about 2,700 students across four countries.**

EDUCATION

- **PhD, Bioinformatics** — National University of Singapore (2010)
- **MSc, Bioinformatics** — National University of Singapore (2005)
- **BAppSc (Hons), Biotechnology** (minor in Scientific Computation & Multimedia Communication) — NUS (2003)
- **Nationality: Singaporean · Languages: English & Malay (written & spoken) · Urdu (conversational) · Hindi (spoken) · Arabic (read & written)**

A full academic curriculum vitae (publications, grants, teaching, and service in detail) is available on request.